

UNIT 59



TIME TO TALK

CONVERSATION

William: Hey Brianna—got a sec? I've been replaying that meeting in my head, and I want to clear the air before the client calls. I don't want this to sit between us or mess with how we work together.

Brianna: When you brought up the missing numbers in front of Marcelo, I took it the wrong way. It felt like I was being called out publicly. On top of that, the scope changed this morning, and I was already pretty stressed.

William: I hear you. It came across as too harsh, and that's on me. I wasn't trying to step on your toes; I was just trying to avoid a surprise mid-call. I should've pulled you aside instead of saying it in the room, I get that now, and I'm sorry.

Brianna: I appreciate that. I'm not trying to blow it out of proportion. It just really sucks when it happens in front of other people. And another thing is, I've never actually seen the updated file. On top of that, my notifications were muted, so I was still working off the old attachment.

William: Okay—then let's clear up a misunderstanding: I dropped the update in the group chat, not email. I'll resend it right now as "FINAL" and highlight the key parts. What's more, I'll add a quick summary so you can pick it up fast. Then I guess we can talk it out and move on.



VOCABULARY



Talk it out



Clear the air



Make it right



Clear up a misunderstanding



Take it the wrong way



Blow out of proportion



Step on someone's toes



Come across as

Adding points

Let's stick to the version we agreed on, so we don't end up correcting each other mid-call. **Also**, it keeps the message clean and avoids any weird tension.

Yeah, that works. I'll follow your lead on the numbers and keep my comments tight. **What's more**, if the client asks for any change, we can note it and talk it out later instead of debating it live.



Connectors of addition

also

on top of that...

what's more...

besides...

and another thing

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EXERCISE 1

Complete each sentence with the most adequate expression from the box. Use each one once.

clear the air | talk it out | make it right | clear up a misunderstanding | take it the wrong way | blow it out of proportion | step on someone's toes | come across as too harsh

- A. I don't want this to feel weird between us—can we _____ before the next meeting?
- B. Let's just _____ for five minutes and move on.
- C. I know I messed up the file version. Let me _____.
- D. I think you might have gotten it wrong. Let's _____.
- E. I'm sorry—I think you _____. I wasn't blaming you.
- F. It's one small mistake. Let's not _____.
- G. I didn't mean to _____ by changing your things without telling you.
- H. Reading it back, that message might _____.

EXERCISE 2

Continue the text with 4 more sentences. Each sentence must start with a connector of addition (also / on top of that... / what's more... / besides... / and another thing is...).

I sent the update in the group chat, not by email. 1 _____

_____.

2. _____

_____.

3. _____

_____.

4. _____

_____.

SUMMARY

Connector	Nuance	Short example
also	neutral add-on	We'll use the final deck. Also , I'll send it now.
what's more	strengthens the point (often a bonus)	We can keep the same structure. What's more , it'll save time.
besides	another reason	Let's not change it now. Besides , we can't test it.
and another thing is	signals a small shift in topic	I'll resend it as "FINAL." And another thing is , don't open the old link.
on top of that	adds extra pressure, complicating the situation;	The scope changed. Also , they added two deliverables. On top of that , they moved the deadline up.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. clear the air
- B. talk it out
- C. make it right
- D. clear up a misunderstanding
- E. took it the wrong way
- F. blow it out of proportion
- G. step on your toes
- H. come across as too harsh

Exercise 2

Answers vary.